Acme Corp Employee HR Handbook

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URL: https://portal.company.com/hr/handbook

1 Introduction

This handbook explains the HR policies that apply to all permanent and fixed-term employees of Acme Corp. Contractors should refer to their agency agreement. Where local law gives an employee more generous rights than this handbook, local law always applies. Questions about anything in this handbook can be raised through the HR Portal (portal.company.com/hr) or by emailing hr-helpdesk@company.com.

2 Working Hours and Attendance

2.1 Standard Hours

The standard working week is 40 hours, normally Monday to Friday, 9:00 to 18:00 with a one-hour lunch break. Core collaboration hours are 11:00 to 16:00 local time, during which employees are expected to be reachable.

2.2 Flexible Working

Employees may request a flexible schedule (for example 8:00 to 17:00, or a compressed four-and-a-half-day week) through the HR Portal under My Profile > Work Arrangement. Requests are approved by the line manager within 10 working days.

2.3 Overtime

Overtime must be approved in advance by the line manager. Non-exempt employees are paid overtime at 1.5 times the hourly rate. Exempt employees may take time off in lieu (TOIL) within 60 days of the overtime worked.

3 Public Holidays

Acme Corp observes the public holidays of the country in which the employee is contracted. The holiday calendar for each office is published every December in the HR Portal under Company Calendar. If a public holiday falls on a weekend, the next working day is given as a substitute holiday.

4 Leave Policy

4.1 Annual Leave

Full-time employees receive 24 working days of paid annual leave per calendar year, accrued monthly (2 days per month). Part-time employees receive a pro-rata entitlement. Up to 5 unused days may be carried over to the following year and must be used by 31 March; any remaining carried-over days are forfeited. Annual leave should be requested at least 2 weeks in advance for absences longer than 3 days.

4.2 Sick Leave

Employees receive 12 days of paid sick leave per calendar year. Sick leave is applied for through the same process as medical leave: HR Portal > Leave Management > Apply for Leave, choosing the leave type "Sick Leave". You must inform your line manager before 10:00 on the first day of absence. A doctor's certificate (medical certificate) is required if the sick leave lasts more than 3 consecutive days; upload it in the Leave Management section within 2 working days of returning to work. Sick leave does not carry over to the next year.

4.3 Medical Leave

Medical leave covers planned medical procedures, surgery, hospitalisation and recovery periods, and extended treatment. Employees may take up to 30 days of paid medical leave per year in addition to sick leave. Medical leave longer than 30 days is reviewed by HR and may move to the long-term disability programme. See Section 5.1 for how to apply.

4.4 Parental Leave

Birthing parents receive 26 weeks of fully paid parental leave. Non-birthing parents (including adoptive parents) receive 12 weeks of fully paid leave, which may be taken in up to three blocks within 12 months of the child's birth or placement. Notify HR at least 8 weeks before the expected start date.

4.5 Bereavement Leave

Employees receive 5 days of paid bereavement leave for the loss of an immediate family member (spouse or partner, child, parent, sibling) and 2 days for extended family. No documentation is required.

4.6 Unpaid Leave and Sabbaticals

After 3 years of service, employees may request up to 3 months of unpaid sabbatical leave. Requests require approval from the line manager and the HR Business Partner and should be submitted at least 3 months in advance.

5 Applying for Leave

5.1 How to Apply for Medical Leave

You can apply for medical leave via the HR Portal > Leave Management. The direct link is portal.company.com/hr/leave. Select "Apply for Leave", choose the leave type "Medical Leave", enter the start and end dates and add a short note for your manager. You need to attach supporting documents (a doctor's note, hospital letter or treatment plan) if your medical leave exceeds 3 days. For planned procedures, apply at least 5 working days before the leave starts. In an emergency, inform your manager by phone and submit the request within 2 working days of returning.

5.2 Approval Workflow

All leave requests go to your line manager for approval. Managers must approve or decline within 3 working days; if they do not, the request is escalated automatically to the next-level manager. Medical leave over 10 days is additionally reviewed by your HR Business Partner. You will receive an email and a portal notification when the status changes.

5.3 Cancelling or Changing Leave

To cancel or change an approved leave request, open HR Portal > Leave Management > My Requests, select the request and choose "Withdraw" or "Modify". Leave that has already started can only be changed by your HR Business Partner.

5.4 Checking Your Leave Balance

Your remaining annual, sick and medical leave balances are shown on the Leave Management dashboard. Balances update overnight after a request is approved.

6 Payroll and Benefits

6.1 Pay Dates

Salaries are paid monthly on the 25th. If the 25th falls on a weekend or public holiday, payment is made on the previous working day. Payslips are available in the HR Portal under Payroll > Payslips from the 23rd of each month.

6.2 Updating Bank Details

To change the bank account your salary is paid into, go to HR Portal > Payroll > Bank Details. Changes submitted before the 15th take effect in the same month's payroll. For security, a confirmation code is sent to your registered mobile number.

6.3 Health Insurance

All employees and their dependants are covered by the company health insurance plan from the first day of employment. Insurance cards and the provider network are available under Benefits > Health Insurance. Dependants can be added within 30 days of a qualifying life event (marriage, birth, adoption).

6.4 Learning Budget

Each employee has an annual learning budget of USD 1,500 for courses, certifications and conferences. Requests are made in the HR Portal under Learning > Request Training and approved by the line manager.

7 Performance and Development

7.1 Review Cycle

Performance reviews run twice a year, in June and December. Each review includes a self-assessment, manager assessment and a development plan. Ratings use a 5-point scale.

7.2 Probation

New employees complete a 90-day probation period. A probation review meeting with the line manager is held in week 11.

8 Code of Conduct and Grievances

8.1 Raising a Concern

Employees can raise a grievance with their line manager, their HR Business Partner, or anonymously through the Ethics Hotline at ethics.company.com. All reports are investigated confidentially, and retaliation against anyone raising a concern in good faith is prohibited.

8.2 Resignation and Notice Period

The notice period is 1 month during probation and 2 months afterwards (3 months for Director level and above). Resignations are submitted in writing through HR Portal > My Profile > Resign, which starts the offboarding checklist.